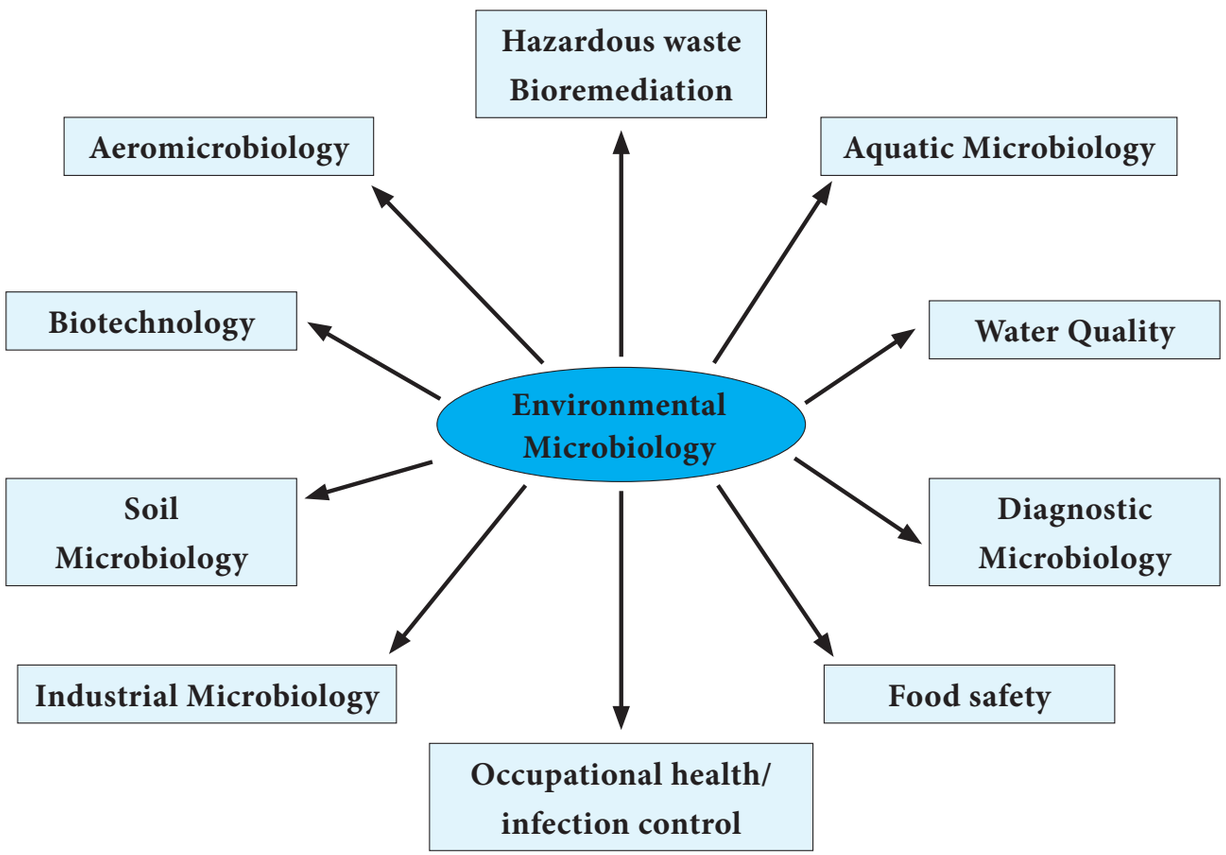
Chemical pollutants in soil and ground water have pronounced effects on human population. The cost of cleanup or remediation of the contaminated sites is too high. The overall objective of this chapter is to define the important microbes involved in environmental microbiology, the nature of the different possible environments in which the microbes are situated, the methodologies used to monitor the microbes and their activities and finally the possible effects of the microbes on human activities.

9.1 Interrelationship with other Fields

Since environmental microorganisms affect so many aspects of life and are easily transported between environments, the field of Environmental Microbiology interfaces with a number of subspecialities. It includes soil, aquatic, aeromicrobiology, as well as bioremediation, Water quality, Occupational health, Infection control, Food safety and Industrial Microbiology.



Modern environmental microbiology has a much wider scope. There are many different fields which recognises the problems in various fileds of Environmental Microbiology. It includes discovery and identification of new microbes and their products that may have practical application for protection of environment and human health and commercial applications.

TN_GOVT_XI_Micro_Biology_CH09.indd 123 16-02-2019 10.02.22 AM